THE SHADOW SPREADSHEET

The new system went live. The spreadsheet never left.

I've seen it in banks and in small businesses.

WHY PEOPLE LOVE IT

It's not a spreadsheet. It's the process.

Database, macros, pivots, charts. The whole job is built around it.

THEN THEY AUTOMATE

The parallel run never ends.

The same data, keyed into the spreadsheet and the new system.

THE RESULT

The automation doubled the work.

More hours, not fewer.

THE REAL REASON

Excel they can fix. The system they can't.

If the system breaks, they wait and pay. So the spreadsheet stays as the backup.

AFTER THE TRIAL RUN

1 Prove the system works

2 Make sure the team can run it themselves

3 Retire the spreadsheet

Keep both running and you've doubled the work, not automated it.